

EMPLACED CARTOGRAPHIES: RECONCEPTUALISING CAMERA PHONE PRACTICES IN AN AGE OF LOCATIVE MEDIA

Abstract

In the context of the increased use of high-quality camera phones, along with the growth in distribution services via social and locative media, we are witnessing new forms of visibility emerging. These new types of 'co-present' visibility overlay and interweave online and offline cartographies in different ways – maps that require a revision of ethnography. In this article, we frame this phenomenon as a shift from networked visibility to emplaced visibility and sociality. That is, we reflect upon previous models deployed in mobile communication and depart from them to consider how a phenomenological approach – rooted in visual and multisensorial ethnography – might help provide insight into this dynamic media cartography and the socialities associated with it.

With the rise of high-quality camera phones, accompanied by the growth in in-phone editing applications and distribution services via social and locative media, we are witnessing the appearance of new types of co-present visibility and sociality. These emergent ways in which online and offline cartographies are becoming overlaid and entangled – as well as the experiential environments associated with them – demand alternative ways of theorising visibility and socialities of co-presence. This requires that we go beyond earlier studies of camera phones (e.g. by Ito and Okabe, 2003, 2005, 2006), which focused on the three 'Ss' – sharing, storing and saving – to inform the *context* of what was predominantly 'banal' everyday *content* (Koskinen, 2007). Moreover, these earlier studies forwarded the idea of 'ambient co-presence' (Ito and Okabe, 2006) in which burgeoning community platforms such as Flickr and social media like Facebook, and camera phone practices, embodied not only 'networked visibility' but also emergent forms of user creativity (Mørk Petersen, 2009; Burgess, 2008). Departing from these ideas, we develop the notion of emplaced visibility.

Emplaced visibility means understanding camera phone practices and the socialities that create and emerge through them in ways corresponding with non-representational (Thrift, 2008) or 'more-than-representational' approaches in geography, which, according to Hayden Lorimer, encompass:

how life takes shape and gains expression in shared experiences, everyday routines, fleeting encounters, embodied movements, precognitive triggers, affective intensities, enduring urges, unexceptional interactions and sensuous dispositions (Lorimer, 2005: 84).

Thus we see camera phone photography as part of the flow of everyday life, an increasingly habitual way of being that is sensed and felt (emotionally and physically). In doing so, we join other contemporary ethnographic scholars who go beyond the content of digital photography to stress the importance of a focus on practice and the non-representational (e.g. Gómez Cruz, 2012).

However, because camera phone photography involves the production and sharing of images, it also compels us to engage with its status as representation, and to explore the relationship between the representational and the non-representational. This tension forms part of our exploration of how we might begin to theorise the shift from *networked* to *emplaced* visuality and sociality, and may be examined through a focus on movement. Tim Cresswell has suggested that we consider ‘three aspects of mobility: the fact of physical movement – getting from one place to another; the representations of movement that give it shared meaning; and, finally, the experienced and embodied practice of movement’ (Cresswell, 2010: 19). These three aspects of mobility are deeply interwoven and entangled. In camera phone photography, the experience and representation of movement cohere, and below we explore how these dimensions of mobility might be situated.

To achieve this, we draw on a set of related theoretical concepts that enable us to understand the socialities and visualities of camera phone photography as part of a constantly shifting ecology: place, movement and perception (see also Pink, 2009, 2012). Following the ideas of Tim Ingold, we see place as ‘unbounded’, a ‘meshwork’ or entanglement of lines of movement, constituted through the intensities through which these lines become entangled with each other (Ingold, 2008). Thus conceived, place can be constituted of any of the diverse components that might come together to create such intensities. As human subjects are inevitably emplaced (see also Casey, 1996), we share contemporary places with, and are situated in relation to, human and non-human organisms, technologies, software, code, energy, the weather, moralities, discourses and more. Place is also imbued with relations of power and finance, corporate and non-corporate entities. As part of place, human subjects and other things and processes are constantly moving through. This is how place, as a forever reconstituting ‘constellation of processes’ (Massey, 2005: 141), shifts and changes. As Ingold (2008) and Doreen Massey (2005) both stress, movement is part of the constituting of place. Moreover, as Ingold’s work shows us, as we move through the places of which we are part, we also continually sense and learn; Ingold argues that,

People do not ‘make sense’ of things by superimposing ready-made sensory meanings ‘on top’ of lived experience, so as to give symbolic shape to the otherwise formless material of raw sensation. They do so, rather, by weaving together, in narrative, strands of experience born of practical, perceptual activity. It is out of this interweaving that meanings emerge. (2011: 326)

Along similar lines, Barbara Maria Stafford writes of learning as ‘incremental and endless, yielding associations that allow us to wander off inventively and independently into new territory’ (2011: 58). We conceptualise camera phone photography as part of this process, as it is enacted in the ‘flow’ of everyday life at the interface where digital and material realities come together.

Accounting for the digital architectures of the banal

As we noted above, in the first series of camera phone studies, the likes of Mizuko Ito and Daisuke Okabe (2003, 2005, 2006) noted the pivotal role played by the three ‘Ss’ – sharing, storing and saving – in informing the context of what was predominantly ‘banal’, everyday content (Koskinen, 2007). For Ilpo Koskinen, camera phone images were branded by their participation in a new type of banality (2007). While this banality

can be seen as extending the conventions and genres of earlier photographic tropes (i.e. Kodak – Gye, 2007; Hjorth, 2007; Lee, 2005), they also significantly depart (Chesher, 2012). Yet the banality of the camera phone should not be understood only in terms of the visual content of the images it produces, but also in its very use. It has become an embedded part of the ordinary – the routine, habitual and often-tacit practices in which we engage as we move through, sense and perceive environments. Therefore, as camera phones become more commonplace in the explosion of smartphones – along with new contexts for image distribution, like microblogging and location-based services (LBS) – emergent types of visual overlays become apparent, and are indeed emerging from a contemporary form of everydayness in which camera phone photography participates. To comprehend this further, we need to locate the ‘ambient visibility’ of these images, in relation to Web 2.0 contexts, in which the geographic is overlaid with the social and emotional.

William Uricchio draws our attention to the algorithmic architecture of Web 2.0 contexts in a way that, as he points out himself, is compatible with the emergent and moving qualities of images (Uricchio, 2011: 28). Uricchio’s study focuses on Photosynth and augmented reality, yet his argument has wider relevance. He argues that these applications ‘share a fundamental realignment of subject–object relations thanks to their algorithmic processing layer’, which resituates human agency and the ‘fixities of the world viewed’, and ‘determines *what* we see, and even *how* we see it’ (2011: 33). This ‘algorithmic turn’ also forms part of the context whereby Francesco Lapenta suggests ‘imaging technologies are responsible for a new epistemological shift that is redefining the perceptual and symbolic relation between mediated representations and the real objects of reference’ (2011: 16–17). Lapenta comprehends the digital map through a consideration of its changing status as photography, in that:

The initially mechanically divided images of the world are digitally reunited in the virtual map, geolocationally pinned down by geomedia technologies, juxtaposed and merged as the jigsaw pieces of an intricate puzzle. (Lapenta, 2011: 17)

Yet the virtual map serves as more than a composite image to be surveyed; rather, in the Web 2.0 context that we consider here, it creates part of the organising architecture for contemporary and emergent forms of sociality and digital practice. Thus, for Lapenta:

... the body, and its location ... become a system of reference used to search and organise the collective information flows that converge and constitute the virtual map in a fashion significant for the individual constituting technological engagements with ‘a multi-sensorial organisation of the increasingly multimodal and hybridised nature of the information space (2011: 20).

Jason Farman also writes of the digital map in relation to ‘a social network that engages users as embodied interactors rather than disembodied voyeurs’ (2010: 869). As these understandings make clear, the digital map and its augmented reality do not exist purely for our visual contemplation. Rather, they make and are part of environments, imply movement and are experienced corporeally. These works offer us a way to understand the invisible architectures of what we refer to as ‘emplaced visibility’, and camera phone photography is part of the way that human subjects, images and socialities become emplaced in relation to these emergent structures and the corporate interests that drive them (see Lapenta, 2011; Farman, 2010).

Simultaneous with the emergence of these algorithmic architectures, the changing nature of the images that ordinary camera phone users themselves can make calls on us to attend to the composition, genre and referentiality of contemporary images, along with their relationality to written text. While, globally, camera phone genres like self-portraiture have blossomed, we are also witnessing the flourishing of vernacular visibilities that reflect

a localised notion of place, social and identity-making practices (Lee, 2009a; Hjorth, 2007). With LBS like Facebook Places, and LBS games like Foursquare and Jiebang, we see a further extension of overlaying locality with the social and personal, whereby the electronic is superimposed on to the geographic in new ways. This overlaying thus makes place through engagements with it. Specifically, by sharing an image and comment about a place through LBS, users can create different ways to experience and record journeys and, in turn, impact upon how place is recorded, experienced and thus remembered (Hjorth and Gu, 2012). This is especially the case with the overlaying of ambient images within moving narratives of place as afforded by LBS.

Moreover, with the burgeoning of smartphones that enable new forms of distribution, we also see a plethora of apps, filters and lenses to help users create 'unique' and artistic camera phone images. Although iPhone has been quick to capitalise on this phenomenon through applications such as Hipstamatic, other smartphones like Android have also attempted to corner this expansive market. So too, social media like microblogs and LBS have acknowledged the growing power of camera phone photography by not only affording easy uploading and sharing of the vernacular (Burgess, 2008), but also providing filters and lenses to further enhance the 'professional' and 'artistic' dimensions of the photographic experience (Mørk Petersen, 2009).

Therefore, we are seeing the emergence of a context where mobile media evokes a particular kind of ambient participation that is configured through and by place in specific ways (Hjorth et al., 2012). One way of conceptualising the various dimensions of this has been suggested by Daniel Palmer, for whom iPhone photography is distinctive across three areas (2012). First, it created an experience between touch and the image, what Palmer calls an 'embodied visual intimacy' (2012: 88). While 'touch has long been an important, but neglected, dimension in the history of photography ... the iPhone, held in the palm of the hand, reintroduces a visual intimacy to screen culture that is missing from the larger monitor screen' (Palmer, 2012: 88). Second, the proliferation of photo apps for the iPhone has meant that there is a plethora of ways to take, edit and share photos. No longer do camera phone images have to look like the poorer cousin to the professional camera. Third, there is the role of GPS capability with the iPhone, automatically 'tagging photographs with their location, allowing images to be browsed and arranged geographically' (Palmer, 2012: 88). In this context, with the convergence of social, locative and mobile media, the way in which we conceptualise camera phone visuality and affect is changing. So how do we frame these new visualities in motion? One way, as we suggest here, is through the movement from 'network' to emplacement, as outlined above. Indeed, this already has a certain 'fit' with the more practical and empirical ways with which scholars such as Palmer are already conceptualising the different dimensions of our engagements with camera phones.

In the following sections, we explore how this theoretical focus on emplacement might be applied critically to depart from existing notions of network and embodiment as ways of conceptualising camera-phone practices.

Photoshopping: New visualities in motion

In studies of first-generation camera phone studies in Korea, Hjorth noted tensions around camera phones' relationship to place and mobility in what she called 'snapshots of almost contact' (2007). The increasingly quick edit and deletion of images at the time has created a different relationship between recording; within this process, fetishisation of realism prevailed. This tension around mediation, reflection and engagement is amplified in second-generation camera phone studies, with the growth of locative and social media that converge various cartographies across spatial, social and electronic terrains. As

previously noted, these cartographies are about mobile intimacy and the ways in which these practices get mapped across the various and competing intimate publics.

As Goggin (2011: 48) notes, the rise of the citizen journalist has been epitomised by the camera phone revolution, to the extent that even some professional photojournalists have opted for camera phones instead of professional cameras (Palmer, 2012). As Daniel Rubinstein and Katrina Sluis (2008) note, the rise of the camera phone has been part of a shift from print-based to screen-based photography. As they observe, 'today, the overwhelming majority of personal photographs are destined never to appear on paper' (2008: 13). While digital photography has far from diminished the importance of the analogue – indeed, the digital is 'haunted' by the analogue in its aesthetics, genres and software names – the tactility of the artefacts is still omnipresent. People touch their screens, zooming in and out of the photo. And thanks to the portability of digital photography via social and mobile media contexts, millions are now walking around with thousands of pictures in their pocket. The old priority of grabbing the photo albums from the burning house has become a way of the past. But now, the fear is about the reappropriation of personal images by companies as part of data aggregation, whereby the relationship between context and content has become even more distorted.

Conventionally, personal photography could be understood as a genre that, as Patricia Holland has argued, is 'a minor discourse, a knowledge without authority, designed to be *used* by a limited number of individuals' (2004: 158). Holland argues that it is important for us to attend to personal photography 'precisely because of this special quality, this everyday unimportance' (Holland, 2004: 158). Yet locative media invite us to understand a new dimension of personal photography. As Rubinstein and Sluis note, this rise of photo-sharing sites has created a context 'vernacular photographers have always lacked: a broad audience' (Rubinstein and Sluis, 2008: 18). Thus, building on Holland's point, we argue that personal photography in the form of camera phone photography makes it all the more important to attend to how everyday images are participating in new ways.

Moreover, as we argue in this article, new theoretical and methodological approaches are required for this purpose. The rise of moblogging has seen a proliferation of camera phone images as often these images can evoke much more than words. In China, an example of this can be found in Weibo, a rich media Chinese version of Twitter, where millions of camera phone images are shared every day. The participatory elements of sites like Flickr, with what Burgess has called their 'vernacular' and 'situated' creativity, (2008) have created new forms of what Søren Mørk Petersen calls 'common banalities' (2008). For Rubinstein and Sluis, the increasing 'reliance on tagging for organisation and retrieval of images is an indication of the importance of textuality for online photographic procedures ... Tagging provides a substantially different way of viewing and interacting with personal photography' (2008: 19). According to Rubinstein and Sluis, these networked images are transformed as part of metadata in which the original context is lost.

Since its introduction in 2007, the iPhone camera has quickly grown from one of the lesser quality lenses to becoming a key contributor in the global phenomenon of images that converge social, locative and mobile media. It has opened up new forms of image taking, editing and sharing, and in turn created new social and geographic cartographies for images. For Chris Chesher (2012), the iPhone camera represents a new 'universe of reference'. He observes that the rise of smartphones like the iPhone – with their attendant software applications like Instagram, Google Goggles and Hipstamatic – has created new ways in which to think about camera phone practices as being between image and information. As Chesher notes, the iPhone 'universe of reference' disrupts the genealogy of mass amateur photography.

With these new applications, often working in collaboration with social and locative media, camera phone images have been given new contexts. These contexts weave in

various cartographies and social tapestries simultaneously, and require us to rethink the relationship between the image and its context (see Pink, 2011). As we noted above, they stand for a shift away from print media, and a world where (at least some genres of) personal photography is produced not for a small circle of family, and stored materially in an album, but may also be viewed by wider audiences. Rather than images being viewed as snapshots that seize a moment, instead these emergent visualities are about a diversity of moments within particular forms of time and space. These temporal-spatial visual configurations are no longer isolated and frozen, as suggested by a snapshot, but are part of a moving set of cartographies orchestrated by the rise of locative services as part of everyday mobile media.

Geographies of visual intimacy: Social, locative and mobile media visualities

Rubinstein and Sluis's (2008) study of the networked image operates as a precursor to the second generation of camera phone practices, in which GPS creates new levels for recording the 'original' context with a geographic coordinate. This capacity to geo-locate, or tag, camera phone images invites us to conceptualise the production and consumption of images through movement and place, and to consider the multisensoriality of images and the emplacement of both the encounters through which they were produced as well as the contexts in which they are viewed (see Pink, 2011). Therefore, rather than viewing networked images as part of a-contextualised metadata, as suggested by Rubinstein and Sluis, we might argue that locative media provide new ways in which to frame images with the 'continuities of everyday movement, perceiving and meaning-making' (Pink, 2011: 4). By contrasting 'photographs as mapped points in a network' with 'photographs being outcomes of, and inspirations within, continuous lines that interweave their way through an environment – that is, in movement and as part of a configuration of place' (Pink, 2011: 4–5), we can conceive of images as produced and consumed in movement. Here, we can think about how images are being transformed in light of various turns – algorithmically, emotionally, with mobility and multisensorially.

Indeed, of all the areas to be impacted and affected, camera phones – especially with their haptic (touch) screen interface and engagement, along with their locative media possibilities – can be seen as indicative of the need for a multisensorial conceptualisation of images. Thus, as we suggested above, we can conceptualise camera phone visuality as 'emplaced', not 'networked'; whereby photographs are not 'an intersection of nodes in networks' but are being both produced within and moving themselves as part of 'a meshwork of moving things' (Pink, 2011: 8). Such movement encompasses 'moving through localities and ... moving across a screen, and the multisensoriality that each of these implies' (Pink, 2011: 8–9).

Therefore, when we think of camera phone photography as situated within a route that the photographer and camera take through and as part of a place, we can begin to consider how the images produced are outcomes of that particular experience and context of emplacement. Yet this emplacement can be experienced in multiple ways that cross material and Web 2.0 contexts. For example, in 2011, Sarah Pink and Lisa Servon developed a study of the development of the Slow City movement in Spain (Pink and Servon, forthcoming). As part of this, Pink took a series of iPhone photographs of a tour of the town of Lekeitio in the Basque Country. These photographs, taken as she walked through the town, were – following the framework presented above – the outcome of that particular social and material configuration through which she encountered the town. They were also taken at a location between the sun overhead and the ground underfoot. The images were therefore the outcomes of this total environment and, as the anthropological

film theorist David MacDougall put it when writing about film, they were ‘corporeal images’ (2005) standing for the situatedness of the photographer as part of an environment.

Following this theoretical and analytical prism, we can understand camera phone photographs not as simply ‘of something that is in front of the camera, that is then recorded in an image, the content of which we might analyse’. Instead, we can see images as emplaced in relation to what Ingold has called a ‘meshwork’ of lines (2008), the images themselves being part of such lines that they are inextricable from the person and camera who took them. In this sense, camera phone images are not simply about what they represent (although they are also about that); they are additionally about what is behind, above, below and to either side.

This was, of course, the case for analogue photography too; we have always taken photographs in and as part of movement through an environment (see Pink, 2011, where this argument is extended). Yet the Web 2.0 context enables us to engage with this idea anew, in practical as well as philosophical ways: the photographs that Pink took on her tour of Lekeitio were also geotagged. Being viewed from above meant that it was possible to locate exactly where in a digital map they had been taken, thus digitally relocating the emplacement of an image on a map. In a contemporary context, therefore, it is not simply that camera phone images are emplaced as the outcomes of material everyday realities, but rather that they are inextricable from their double emplacement in digital maps. Because their visibility is doubly emplaced, it creates a bond between the materialities of the ground underfoot and the sky overhead, with the digital architectures of Web 2.0 that also frame and are framed by our movements through the world. When we think of images only as representations of what it was that was seen through the lens, we miss the point that images are inextricably the outcomes of the material and the digital, and also that the algorithmic architectures (see Uricchio, 2011) discussed above – software and web platforms – also constitute elements in the way this practice is emplaced.

Although this example from Pink’s work demonstrates how camera phone photography becomes part of the way we create traces through environments, and how they might become relevant to an ethnographer considering her research process, it does not tell us about the social potential of Web 2.0. Yet, in a Web 2.0 context, camera phone images are often produced with web platforms in mind, to digitally share (see Gómez Cruz, 2012). This is shown, as discussed elsewhere (Hjorth, Wilken and Gu, 2012; Hjorth and Gu, 2012), in Shanghai with the uptake of the LBS mobile game Jiebang, where users can ‘check in’ to online spaces and visit offline places and win prizes – which is creating out-of-game visualities. Since its inception two years ago, Jiebang’s three million users have generated 50 million check-ins globally, with more than 8.2 million photos uploaded.

For many of the Generation Y (*ba ling hou*) respondents, the playing of the official Jiebang game is secondary to social motivation. In this social dimension, the use – with accelerated frequency – of sharing camera phone pictures has become a key practice. Accompanied with the rise of rich-media moblogging such as Sina and Weibo and SNS Renren (China’s Facebook), the compulsion to photograph, edit and share is growing. In each of the different social media spaces, types of photographic genres can be found. For example, many use Sina for self-portraiture, Weibo for more political or newsworthy images and Renren as a space for reflecting inner feelings. In the case of Jiebang, visibility is more about new types of place-making. These place-making exercises are like diaries (Ito and Okabe, 2005) but with the active use of filters and perspectives, Jiebang is demonstrating emergent forms of creative practice for the *ba ling hou*. In doing so, it invites us to consider how camera phone practices are mapped on to socialities and, in diary format, the shifting temporalities of the visual/socialities that are part of such places.

In fieldwork in six locations in the Asia-Pacific region, Hjorth and Arnold observed the significance of camera phone photography in the place-making exercises of LBS

(Hjorth and Arnold, 2013). They note that in LBS photo albums, while respondents used traditional genres like food and places, they did so by using filters and lenses to create highly aesthetic images. Far from being banal and boring, the images were often unique and creative. They are not only about the vernacular qualities of user-created content (UCC) – they signal new types of emplaced visualities and ambient intimacy (Ito and Okabe, 2005). As this case study highlights, the software is part of the ways in which images are emplaced: often filters were used that not only made the pictures look analogue but also gave them a sense of nostalgia. This ‘fastforwarding present/presence’ (Hjorth, 2007) of camera phones as images in a movement and event took on a specific ‘emplaced’ ambivalence with LBS. Through the overlaying of highly edited camera phone image and comment, respondents can narrate place in new ways. Often the visuals are deployed to present a unique image of the locality – whether through the image genre or, more often, by using filters and lenses to create a mood.

Respondents also spoke of the importance of social capital (*guanxi*) in motivating them to take and share pictures via Jiebang. Jiebang, however, does not attract the same debate about privacy, partly because of culturally specific notions like *guanxi*. For Cara Wallis, *guanxi* is a ‘widely used yet ambiguous’ term that can mean many things: relationships, personal connections and social networks. As Wallis (2011) observes, in Beijing the deployment of social and mobile media is closely bounded by the notion of *guanxi*. Rather than being about memory and place, LBS camera phone practices were about creating new narratives between presence, present and placing. In this sense, we suggest that camera phone pictures are used to situate users not simply geographically or digitally, but also socially, through the use of their visual, locative and digital situatedness in relation to material, social and online contexts.

Thus they can be used in the making of social capital in ways that interweave or entangle the social, material and digital. With the additional dimension of camera phones interwoven with locative media, *guanxi* and place can take on more complex cartographies that place, emplace and embody visualities. Camera phone practices, therefore, have the effect of creating digital traces as their users move through material and sensory environments. In doing so, they enable a form of emplacement that encompasses both material, software and Web 2.0 contexts, weaving routes simultaneously through both, and constituting places where the online and offline are mutually entangled in a shared ‘meshwork’. All respondents noted that Jiebang inspired them to take more camera phone pictures, and thanks to smartphones it was easier to take, edit and share images. Moreover, respondents who used Jiebang progressively felt the need to make visual and textual comments about places, especially encouraged by the idea that images were part of an event, movement or present-ness.

In the case of LBS games, camera phone images are therefore contextualised through both multisensoriality and movement. Not only is the genre and content about narrating place as part of journey and process, but also the frequency and its link to reinforcing the social capital suggest a complex mapping of place, sociality and visibility. This becomes apparent in case studies of LBS games and the logic of emplaced visualities. With LBS creating new cartographies and connections to place, we see visualities move from first-generation networked (Ito and Okabe, 2005) to emplaced visualities. Here we see the interweaving of the visualities and socialities of place in new ways, which can likewise be understood in terms of their mutual emplacement.

In many of the locative camera phone images, the social dimension of the image is brought to the forefront in the overlaying of geographical or locational knowledge. This echoes Ilkka Arminen’s (2006) point that, when it comes to SNS, social context rather than ‘pure geographical location’ is generally of greater user interest. What seems to be most

at stake in LBS games is new knowledge about particular sites and what they are likely to signify within social network settings. LBS, like Jiebang, highlights that the various dimensions around ideas of place – imagined and lived, geographic and psychological – are contextualised by social capital.

Conclusion: Emplaced geospatial visualities and socialities

In LBS games like Foursquare, Jiebang and flags, we are witnessing new types of emplaced visuality and geospatial sociality. Through the locative and microblogging experience of Jiebang, users are creating new forms of intimate publics whereby the importance of network pales into insignificance in comparison with the interweaving of socialities, materialities and the digital in providing ambient contexts. As part of the smartphone phenomenon, LBS games are accompanied by an accelerated rate of camera phone image-taking, editing and sharing. Far from being banal, acontextualised images, these pictures deploy the newest of filters and photographic techniques to give a sense of the poetic and unique, and are then overlaid electronically on to places. This is not a mere practice of networked visuality, as noted by the first studies into camera phones; rather, we see emplaced and multisensorial visuality that creates and reflects unique forms of geospatial sociality.

The traces made as camera phones are used as mobile media weaving through material/digital environments with their users thus become forms of visuality that are emplaced digitally, socially and materially. Their visual content is the outcome of the multiple constituents of place through which they are produced, and in relation to which the body of the photographer is emplaced – including the weather, social relationships, localities, software and code, technologies and human innovation and creativity. These are felt, affective and embodied realities where people's embodied engagements and ways of moving with camera phones should be coming into our focus as researchers. Yet they are also inextricable from social environments, where they likewise play a situated and situating role, as they are engaged in ways that include, but do not refer exclusively to, their status as representations, including the making of the very qualities of social relations that characterise different forms of sociality and, as we have shown, social value and affect. Indeed, a focus on the camera phone offers an important prism through which to understand how these relationships between the materialities and digital environments of place, embodied experience and sociological phenomena converge.

These contemporary shifts are producing significant changes in the ways personal photographs have become part of the everyday world. They are part of a context where the everyday, the mundane, becomes both habitually felt in the practice of taking photographs and, simultaneously, is represented visually on web platforms in ways that forge relationships between the material, the sensory, the social and the digital. These new configurations of persons, things and feelings call for revised theoretical and methodological approaches, which enable us to both comprehend such contemporary realities and to focus back on earlier photographic forms and discover their relevance anew. As we have argued in this article, understanding camera phone photography, its qualities, affordances and the everyday practices in which it is implicated through the theories of place, movement and perception enables us to move on analytically. It invites us to depart from the notion of networked visualities to understand more fully how contemporary visualities and the socialities that are implicated through them are emplaced. It also forms part of a wider context in which we need to focus more closely on the everydayness of media beyond the content, and look at the experiential realities with which it is interwoven.

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